

DESIGN SYSTEM · V1.0 · MAY 2026

SHAVONNE WONG

Precision with undertow. A controlled environment, cool and still, with one accent that appears only as a threshold — a line between one thing and another.

Photography ·
new media

Institutional ·
lab-adjacent

Haze · Slate · Iris ·
Fog · Ghost

Mulish ·
one family

01

Overview

What this system is, who it's for, and the posture it takes.

CONCEPT

Precision with undertow. The brand never announces itself — it lets the work do that. Surfaces are cool, still, and uninflected. The single accent (Iris) appears only as a threshold: a line between one thing and another.

AUDIENCE AND REGISTER

Shavonne Wong is an artist working at the intersection of photography and emerging technology. The practice sits alongside institutional and Art + Tech contexts (LACMA Art + Technology Lab, NAC Singapore, museum and biennale programming). The brand register is international, institutional, and lab-adjacent — not gallery/collector, not startup, not consumer product.

WHAT THIS IS NOT

- Not a product UI brand. It is an artist identity — portfolio site, exhibition collateral, statements, decks, reproductions.
- Not warm, not playful, not loud. If a surface reads warm, something has gone wrong.
- Not branded with iconography, gradients, or decorative flourishes.

HARD RULES — NEVER VIOLATE

#	RULE
1	No emoji. Anywhere — copy, UI, error messages, chat.
2	No serif type. Anywhere.
3	No monospace. Metadata uses the same sans, gently tracked.
4	No gradients, hand-drawn illustrations, or repeating patterns.
5	Iris is a line, not a fill. Used once per view.
6	No drop shadows. No backdrop blur.
7	No marketing voice. Third person, factual, present tense.
8	Radii ≤ 2 px on almost everything (pill is reserved for the SW avatar).

02

Palette

Five values, used in fixed roles. Haze and Slate carry roughly 95% of all surfaces.

Haze #EDED F4 Page · primary background	Slate #1819 2B Type · inverse surface	Iris #545C 9E Threshold line · 1 per view	Fog #8B90 AB Metadata · secondary · disabled	Ghost #D0D3 EC Input fields · image plates
--	--	--	---	---

TOKEN REFERENCE

TOKEN	HEX	ROLE
--sw-haze	#EDED F4	Primary background — cool near-white, faint lavender cast.
--sw-slate	#1819 2B	Primary dark — deep blue-black. Type, inverse surface, primary fill.
--sw-iris	#545C 9E	Accent — used ONCE per view, only as a 0.5 px divider line. Never as text, fill, or background.
--sw-fog	#8B90 AB	Secondary neutral — metadata, secondary text, disabled state.
--sw-ghost	#D0D3 EC	Pale lavender — input field tint, large image plate backgrounds. Never named in voice.
--bg-elev	#F4F4 F8	"Haze elevated" — faint step up for cards. Used instead of shadow.
--sw-rule-light	rgba(24,25,43,.10)	Neutral hairline divider on Haze (Slate at 10%).
--sw-rule-dark	rgba(237,237,244,.12)	Neutral hairline divider on Slate (Haze at 12%).

USAGE RULES

- Haze and Slate carry ~95% of surfaces. If a surface is neither, audit it.
- Iris is a threshold, not a color. One 0.5 px line per view, marking a section break that genuinely matters. Adding a second cheapens the first.
- Fog is for metadata and secondary type only. Never on a primary heading.
- Ghost appears only in product UI surfaces (form fields, image plates). It is never named in voice and never used in print.
- No warm colors, ever. If an image reads orange or amber, it needs a cool grade or it is the wrong image.

03

Typography

One typeface — Mulish. Used at four sizes and three weights. No serif. No monospace.

TYPEFACE

The brand is set entirely in Mulish, a geometric humanist sans in the tradition of Avenir. Wide proportions, soft-but-defined terminals, even strokes. Open-source (SIL OFL), loaded from Google Fonts.

Fallback chain: "Mulish", "Helvetica Neue", Arial, sans-serif

SPECIMENS

SHAVONNE
WONG

Wordmark
Mulish Regular 400
clamp(56, 9vw, 128)px
tracking 0.18em
line-height 0.95
ALL CAPS · left-aligned
two-line stacked

A portrait holds together,
then comes apart.

Display 1 / h1
Mulish Light 300
clamp(40, 6vw, 80)px
tracking -0.01em
line-height 1.05

Selected works, 2020 — 2024.

Display 2 / h2
Mulish Light 300
clamp(28, 4vw, 48)px
tracking -0.005em
line-height 1.25

Works

Heading / h3
Mulish Regular 400
24px
tracking 0
line-height 1.35

Shavonne Wong is an artist working between photography and machine-generated image. Her practice examines how a portrait holds together — and where it begins to come apart — when its substrate becomes a model.

Body
Mulish Regular 400
16px
line-height 1.65
max-width 42–64ch

2024.07 · Singapore, SG · 4K loop · 11:42

Metadata
Mulish Regular 400
13px
tracking 0.04em
tabular numerals
color: Fog

SELECTED WORKS · 2020 — 2024

Eyebrow
Mulish Regular 400
11px
tracking 0.22em
ALL CAPS · color Fog

TYPE SCALE (CSS TOKENS)

TOKEN	SIZE	USE
--t-wordmark	clamp(56, 9vw, 128)px	Wordmark only.
--t-display-1	clamp(40, 6vw, 80)px	Page h1.
--t-display-2	clamp(28, 4vw, 48)px	Section opener h2.
--t-heading	24px	h3 / card title.
--t-subhead	18px	Lead paragraph / subhead.
--t-body	16px	Body copy.
--t-body-sm	15px	Compact body / form labels.
--t-meta	13px	Metadata (dates, locations, mediums).
--t-eyebrow	11px	Tracked ALL CAPS label.

WEIGHT, TRACKING, LEADING

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
--w-light	300	Display headlines (h1, h2).

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
--w-regular	400	Wordmark, body, metadata, eyebrows.
--w-medium	500	Rare emphasis only.
--track-wordmark	0.18em	Wordmark minimum.
--track-display	0.06em	Section openers, ALL CAPS.
--track-eyebrow	0.22em	Tiny tracked label.
--track-meta	0.04em	Metadata — gently tracked sans.
--lh-tight	1.05	Display headlines.
--lh-snug	1.25	Subheads.
--lh-body	1.65	Body copy.

WORDMARK RULES

- Two-line stack — SHAVONNE over WONG — ALL CAPS, Regular 400, left-aligned.
- Tracking ≥ 0.18em. Line-height 0.95.
- The asymmetry (9 letters over 4) is intentional. Never balance or centre.
- Never Bold. Never tight-tracked. Never italic.

04

Spacing, radii & rules

4 px base scale, generous gutters, near-zero radii, hairline-only rules.

SPACING SCALE

--s-1		4px
--s-2		8px
--s-3		12px
--s-4		16px
--s-5		24px
--s-6		32px
--s-7		48px
--s-8		64px
--s-9		96px
--s-10		128px
--s-11		192px

RADII

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
--r-0	0	Default. Images, plates, sections.
--r-1	1px	Hairline lift on small chrome.
--r-2	2px	Buttons, tags — the maximum almost anywhere.
--r-pill	999px	SW avatar mark only.

Soft 12 px+ corners read as "consumer SaaS." Stay tight.

BORDERS & RULES

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
--border-hair	0.5px solid rule	Neutral hairline divider. Slate@10% on Haze, Haze@12% on Slate.
--border-iris	0.5px solid Iris	The threshold. Once per view, treated as a typographic accent.

No 1 px or thicker rules anywhere. Depth is implied by spacing and tonal step (Haze → Haze-elevated), not by borders or shadow.

LAYOUT PRINCIPLES

- Generous margins. Desktop page gutters 64–128 px. Negative space is doing work.
- Left-aligned everything. No centred body. Centred headlines are very rare.
- 12-column grid is implied, not enforced. Most layouts use 1, 2, or 3 columns. Images may break columns.
- Full-bleed imagery is fine and frequent. Edge-to-edge image plates are the loudest the brand gets.

SHADOWS & DEPTH

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
--shadow-none	none	Default for cards, images, popovers.
--shadow-press	0 0 0 1px Iris inset	Pressed state — only place Iris touches a control.

05

Components

A small, opinionated set. Reference, not exhaustive.

BUTTONS



ALL CAPS label, Regular 400, 12-13px, tracking 0.12em, padding 14×28, radius 2px. Press state is an inset 1 px Iris ring — no scale, no shadow.

INDEX ROW (WORKS LISTING)

01 / 03	<i>A Soft Crash, 2024</i>	2024 · generative video
02 / 03	<i>Phantom Limb, 2023</i>	2023 · single-channel · 11:42
03 / 03	<i>No Eye Contact, 2023</i>	2023 · archival pigment

Titles in display Light italic, in-sentence case. Numbering and medium in metadata (Mulish 12-13px, tracking 0.04em, Fog).

CARDS & SURFACES

Cards sit on Haze-elevated (#F4F4F8) or are demarcated by a single hairline on top or bottom — never four sides by default. No shadows. Depth comes from a tonal half-step, not elevation.

FORM FIELDS

Background Ghost (#D0D3EC), 0 border, padding 14×16, radius 2 px. Body 15 px on Slate. Focus state: 1 px Iris ring offset 2 px (same ring as press, but outside).

HEADER & FOOTER

Header: thin row pinned to top. Wordmark or SW avatar at left, sparse nav (ALL CAPS, 12px, tracking 0.18em) at right. No shadow, no border, or a single hairline rule below. Footer: left-aligned metadata in Fog, single Iris threshold rule above. No social icon row, no floating CTA.

SW AVATAR

Slate background, Iris initials in display Light, 14 px tracking 0.14em, pill radius. The single brand-wide use of pill shape and the single context where Iris appears as anything other than a line — and only in small sizes.

06

Motion & states

Slow, controlled, held. No bounce, no overshoot, no spring physics.

EASING & DURATIONS

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
--ease	cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)	The brand easing — flat acceleration, long slowing tail.
--dur-quick	140 ms	Hovers, small state changes.
--dur-base	240 ms	Menus, overlays.
--dur-slow	640 ms	Image and section reveals.

ALLOWED MOTION

- Reveals: opacity 0→1, translate-Y +8 px. Nothing scales, nothing rotates.
- Image tile hover: 200 ms fade to ~85% opacity. No lift, no shadow.
- Text link hover: Slate → Fog (lighter, never darker). Underline may appear on hover, 0.5 px, offset 0.18 em.
- Press: inset 1 px Iris ring. No scale.
- Focus: 1 px Iris ring offset by 2 px.

FORBIDDEN MOTION

- Bounce, overshoot, spring physics.
- Scale or rotate on reveal.
- Parallax.
- Backdrop blur — anywhere.
- Translucent UI surfaces. Hairlines and image-caption overlays excepted (Slate at 60% over imagery).

07

Voice & content

The work speaks. The copy points at it and gets out of the way.

VOICE

- Third-person, factual, present tense. No "we." No "I" outside an artist statement. Most surfaces read like a museum wall label or an archive entry.
- Restraint over claim. State the medium, the date, the title. Skip adjectives. Avoid *stunning, innovative, groundbreaking, explores, challenges, redefines*.
- No marketing voice. No urgency, no enthusiasm, no exclamation points. "Get in touch today!" → "Contact."
- No emoji. Anywhere — copy, UI, chat, error messages. Non-negotiable.

CASING

CONTEXT	CASING
Wordmark & section openers	ALL CAPS, Regular/Light, tracked ≥ 0.18 em
Titles of works	<i>Italic</i> , in-sentence case (<i>A Soft Crash</i> , 2024)
Global nav & section labels	ALL CAPS
Everything else	Sentence case
Metadata	Mixed case as written; tracked sans, Fog color

PUNCTUATION & NUMBERS

- Use the em dash — like this — never " — " with hair spaces.
- Numerals are figures, not spelled out, beyond ten: "10 works," "2024."
- Dates: 2024.07 or "July 2024," never 7/24/24 .
- Locations follow a comma: "Singapore, SG." "Los Angeles, US."

EXAMPLE COPY

Index page:

A Soft Crash, 2024 — generative video, 4K, looped.

Phantom Limb, 2023 — single-channel video, 11:42.

No Eye Contact, 2023 — series, archival pigment print.

About page:

Shavonne Wong is an artist working between photography and machine-generated image.

Based in Singapore. Recent exhibitions include LACMA (2024), NAC Singapore (2023), and Art + Tech Festival, Hong Kong (2023).

Footer:

© 2024 SHAVONNE WONG • STUDIO@SHAVONNEWONG.COM • SINGAPORE, SG

WHAT NOT TO WRITE

"Discover stunning AI artwork that pushes boundaries! 🚀"

Wrong on every axis — adjectives, marketing voice, emoji, exclamation, claim-making verb.

Imagery & iconography

Photography does the heavy lifting. Iconography is almost absent — by design.

IMAGERY CHARACTER

- Cool-leaning, never warm. If a photograph reads orange or amber, it's the wrong photograph or it needs a cool grade.
- Comfortable with black and white, with desaturation, with neutral grays.
- No drop shadows. No rounded corners on images larger than thumbnails.
- Full-bleed image plates are the loudest the brand gets. Use them deliberately.

ICONOGRAPHY RULES

- No emoji. Anywhere.
- No decorative SVG illustrations drawn from scratch. Use a real photograph (placeholder if not yet shot).
- No icon font. No Material, Font Awesome, Heroicons rendered everywhere.
- Functional glyphs only — monoline, 1 px stroke, fills never used, color is `currentColor` (Slate or Fog).
- Source: Lucide. Pull only the glyphs below, not a whole pack.
- Unicode arrows acceptable in body type: → ← ↗.

PERMITTED GLYPH SET

GLYPH	USE
Arrow (←↑→↓)	Next/prev work, back, external link.
Plus / minus	Expand/collapse on FAQ-style content.
Close (x)	Overlays.
Play / pause	Video works only.

09

Implementation

Drop-in CSS reference and file structure.

PROJECT STRUCTURE

README.md	Concept, content & visual foundations, iconography.
SKILL.md	Agent Skill entry point — hard rules & how to use.
colors_and_type.css	All design tokens. Source of truth for CSS variables.
fonts/README.md	Notes on Mulish — weights and treatments in use.
assets/	Logos (Slate / Haze / Iris), favicon.
preview/	Specimen cards for each token.
ui_kits/site/	React prototype of the portfolio site.

FONT LOADING

```
@import url("https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Mulish:wght@300;400;500;600&display=swap");
```

CORE CSS VARIABLES

```
:root {  
  /* Color */  
  --sw-haze: #EDED4;  
  --sw-slate: #18192B;  
  --sw-iris: #545C9E;  
  --sw-fog: #8B90AB;  
  --sw-ghost: #D0D3EC;  
  --sw-rule-light: rgba(24, 25, 43, 0.10);  
  --sw-rule-dark: rgba(237, 237, 244, 0.12);  
  
  /* Semantic surfaces */  
  --bg: var(--sw-haze);  
  --bg-elev: #F4F4F8;  
  --bg-field: var(--sw-ghost);  
  --bg-inverse: var(--sw-slate);  
  --fg: var(--sw-slate);  
  --fg-muted: var(--sw-fog);  
  --fg-inverse: var(--sw-haze);  
  --accent: var(--sw-iris);  
  --rule: var(--sw-rule-light);  
  
  /* Type */  
  --font-display: "Mulish", "Helvetica Neue", Arial, sans-serif;  
  --font-body: "Mulish", "Helvetica Neue", Arial, sans-serif;  
  --w-light: 300; --w-regular: 400; --w-medium: 500;  
  
  --track-wordmark: 0.18em;  
  --track-display: 0.06em;  
  --track-eyebrow: 0.22em;  
  --track-meta: 0.04em;  
  
  --t-wordmark: clamp(56px, 9vw, 128px);  
  --t-display-1: clamp(40px, 6vw, 80px);  
  --t-display-2: clamp(28px, 4vw, 48px);  
  --t-heading: 24px;  
  --t-subhead: 18px;  
  --t-body: 16px;  
  --t-meta: 13px;  
  --t-eyebrow: 11px;  
  
  --lh-tight: 1.05; --lh-snug: 1.25; --lh-body: 1.65;  
  
  /* Spacing (4 px base) */  
  --s-1: 4px; --s-2: 8px; --s-3: 12px; --s-4: 16px;  
  --s-5: 24px; --s-6: 32px; --s-7: 48px; --s-8: 64px;  
  --s-9: 96px; --s-10: 128px; --s-11: 192px;  
  
  /* Radii */
```



```
--r-0:0; --r-1:1px; --r-2:2px; --r-pill:999px;

/* Borders */
--border-hair: 0.5px solid var(--rule);
--border-iris: 0.5px solid var(--sw-iris);

/* Shadow */
--shadow-none: none;
--shadow-press: 0 0 0 1px var(--sw-iris) inset;

/* Motion */
--ease: cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1);
--dur-quick: 140ms; --dur-base: 240ms; --dur-slow: 640ms;
}
```

SLATE INVERSION (DARK SECTIONS)

```
.on-slate {
  --bg:    var(--sw-slate);
  --bg-elev: #1F2138;
  --bg-field: #20223A;
  --fg:    var(--sw-haze);
  --fg-muted: var(--sw-fog);
  --rule:  var(--sw-rule-dark);
  background: var(--bg);
  color:    var(--fg);
}
```

UTILITY CLASSES

CLASS	USE
<code>.sw-wordmark</code>	Two-line stacked wordmark. Apply to a block with <code>SHAVONNE
WONG</code> inside.
<code>.sw-h1</code> / <code>.sw-h2</code> / <code>.sw-h3</code>	Display headlines (Light 300, then Regular 400 at h3).
<code>.sw-body</code>	Body paragraph (max-width 64ch).
<code>.sw-meta</code> / <code>.sw-mono</code>	Small tracked sans with tabular numerals. Metadata.
<code>.sw-eyebrow</code>	11 px ALL CAPS tracked 0.22em. Fog.
<code>.sw-threshold</code>	The Iris hairline. Use ONCE per view.
<code>.sw-avatar</code>	SW initials pill, Iris on Slate.
<code>.on-slate</code>	Add to a region to flip surfaces dark.

